



GHANA PUBLISHING COMPANY LTD

ASSEMBLY PRESS, BARNES ROAD, ACCRA • FINANCE & ACCOUNTS DIRECTORATE

FINANCE & ACCOUNTING OPERATIONS MANUAL

Standard Operating Procedures for General Ledger Accounting, Fast Voucher Entry (F4–F9), Commercial Invoicing, Ghana Statutory Levies, Customer Settlements, Bank Reconciliation & Financial Statements

FINANCE STAFF EDITION

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

FY 2026 / 2027

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1. System Overview & Financial Principles

The **GPCL Finance & Accounting System** is the official accounting platform of **Ghana Publishing Company Limited (Assembly Press)**. It provides complete accounting governance for commercial print jobs, gazette notices, raw materials stock, supplier payments, customer credit management, statutory Ghana taxes, and executive reporting.

FOUR CORE ACCOUNTING SAFEGUARDS

- 1. Double-Entry Balance:** Every voucher and journal entry requires total Debits to equal total Credits to the exact pesewa. Unbalanced entries are rejected.
- 2. Control Account Integrity:** Key control accounts (Trade Receivables #1100, Trade Payables #2001, Material Inventory #1202) cannot receive direct manual journal entries. They update automatically through business transactions to prevent discrepancies.
- 3. Ghana Tax Compliance:** Invoices automatically apply the Ghana statutory levies (15% VAT, 2.5% NHIL, 2.5% GETFund — totaling 20% on net selling price).
- 4. Period Lock Protection:** Closed financial periods reject backdated postings to maintain audit compliance.

2. User Access & Security

Access to the financial portal is restricted to authorized personnel. Each staff member logs in using their corporate email and confidential password.

- **Signing In:** Navigate to the finance portal login screen, enter your corporate email (e.g., sadgei@gpcl.com) and password, then click **Sign In**.
- **Confidentiality:** Never share your password. Every invoice generated, payment collected, or voucher posted is permanently linked to your individual user account.
- **Automatic Session Timeout:** For security, your session locks after **8 hours** of inactivity. Sign in again to resume your work without losing saved records.

3. Financial Overview Dashboard

The Financial Dashboard gives senior management, Chief Accountants, and financial controllers real-time visibility into GPCL's trading performance and cash balances.

TRADE RECEIVABLES (AR) GHS 248,500.00 +12.4% vs last month	GROSS OPERATING PROFIT GHS 330,000.00 51.5% Gross Margin	GHANA LEVIES (VAT/NHIL) GHS 49,700.00 15% VAT 2.5% NHIL 2.5% GET	OPERATING BANK BALANCE GHS 277,500.00 GCB Bank & Ecobank
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Key Dashboard Features

- Monthly Revenue vs. Cost of Goods Sold (COGS):** Comparative bar chart illustrating monthly printing sales against direct paper stock and production costs.
- Operational Expense Distribution:** Visual breakdown tracking Paper Stock COGS (64%), Staff Salaries (10%), Ghana Levies (10%), Office Utilities (4%), and Freight Handling (3%).
- Live General Ledger Activity:** Real-time feed of the latest journal postings from store deliveries, invoices, customer receipts, and gazette checkout.
- Financial Ratios:** Automated liquidity analysis showing Current Ratio (**2.45 : 1**), Quick Ratio (**1.82 : 1**), and Debt-to-Equity Ratio (**0.26 : 1**).

4. High-Speed Voucher Entry Workspace (F4 – F9)

Located under **Accounting** → **Voucher Entry (F4-F9)**, this workstation is built for rapid, mouse-free voucher data entry using standard accounting keyboard shortcuts.

Shortcut	Voucher Type	When to Use This Voucher	Typical General Ledger Accounts
F4	Contra Voucher	Cash deposits into bank, cash withdrawals, inter-bank transfers	Dr Bank Account (1002) / Cr Main Cash (1001)
F5	Payment Voucher	Disbursements for vendor bills, utilities, petty cash expenses	Dr Office Utilities (6400) / Cr GCB Bank (1002)
F6	Receipt Voucher	Direct cash or bank receipts not linked to an invoice (e.g., scrap sales)	Dr GCB Bank (1002) / Cr Sundry Revenue (4200)
F7	Journal Voucher	Non-cash accounting adjustments, accruals, depreciation, corrections	Dr Depreciation / Cr Accumulated Depreciation
F8	Sales Voucher	Direct commercial sales and gazette publishing transactions	Dr Trade Receivables (1100) / Cr Printing Revenue (4001)
F9	Purchase Voucher	Materials stock purchases, raw paper reels, and supplier credit purchases	Dr Paper Stock Inventory (1202) / Cr Accounts Payable (2001)
Ctrl+F8	Credit Note	Customer price allowances, returned printing, billing adjustments	Dr Sales Returns (4200) / Cr Trade Receivables (1100)
Ctrl+F9	Debit Note	Returns of defective printing paper or consumables back to suppliers	Dr Accounts Payable (2001) / Cr Paper Stock Inventory (1202)

DOUBLE-ENTRY BALANCE VERIFICATION

The voucher submission button activates only when total Debits equal total Credits. The footer displays a real-time status banner: ✓ DOUBLE ENTRY BALANCED or ⚠ UNBALANCED VOUCHER.

5. Chart of Accounts & Opening Balances

The Chart of Accounts (**Accounting** → **Chart of Accounts**) is organized using a standardized 4-digit hierarchy:

Code Series	Category	Normal Balance	Key GPCL Accounts
1000 – 1999	ASSET	Debit	1001 Main Cash, 1002 GCB Bank, 1003 Ecobank, 1100 AR, 1201 Finished Goods, 1202 Paper Stock Inventory
2000 – 2999	LIABILITY	Credit	2001 Accounts Payable, 2100 VAT (15%), 2102 NHIL (2.5%), 2103 GETFund (2.5%), 2200 WHT, 2300 PAYE
3000 – 3999	EQUITY	Credit	3001 Stated Capital, 3002 Retained Earnings, 3900 Opening Balance Clearing
4000 – 4999	REVENUE	Credit	4001 Commercial Printing Revenue, 4100 Gazette Publication Revenue, 4200 Sales Returns
5000 – 5999	COGS	Debit	5001 Cost of Goods Sold (Raw Paper Stock, Printing Inks, Binding Consumables)
6000 – 6999	EXPENSE	Debit	6100 Salaries & Wages, 6150 Freight, 6200 Scrap Loss, 6300 Bank Fees, 6400 Utilities & Power

Managing Opening Balances

1. Navigate to the Chart of Accounts list.
2. Locate the target account and click **Edit Opening**.
3. Input the audited starting balance in Ghana Cedis (GHS).
4. Click **Update Opening Balance**. The General Ledger starting position is updated immediately.

6. Journal Entries Register & Ledger Audit

The Journal Entries Register (**Accounting** → **Journal Entries Register**) records every transaction posted to the General Ledger.

Transaction Reversal Workflow (The Audit-Compliant Correction Method)

In compliance with standard accounting practices, posted entries are never deleted. When an entry must be cancelled:

1. Locate the journal in the register (searchable by Entry #, Source Module, or Description).
2. Click **Reverse** in the Actions column.
3. The system marks the original journal status as **REVERSED** and automatically generates an inverse journal entry swapping all debits and credits, permanently linking the correction in the audit trail.

7. Commercial Invoicing & Accounts Receivable (AR)

The Invoicing module (**Finance** → **Invoices & AR**) manages commercial sales invoicing, client credit exposure, Ghana statutory tax calculations, recurring contracts, and print exports.

7.1 Ghana Statutory Tax & Levy Engine

Every commercial sales invoice issued by GPCL automatically applies the Ghana statutory levy breakdown:

- **Net Subtotal:** $\$ \text{sum} (\text{ext}\{\text{Quantity}\} \text{imes ext}\{\text{Unit Selling Price}\}) \$$
- **Value Added Tax (VAT):** $\$ \text{ext}\{\text{Net}\} \text{imes } 15.0\% \$$
- **National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL):** $\$ \text{ext}\{\text{Net}\} \text{imes } 2.5\% \$$
- **Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund):** $\$ \text{ext}\{\text{Net}\} \text{imes } 2.5\% \$$
- **Total Gross Amount Due:** $\$ \text{ext}\{\text{Net}\} \text{imes } 1.20 \$$ (Total effective statutory levy: 20%)

AUTOMATIC GENERAL LEDGER POSTING GENERATED ON INVOICE CREATION

Debit: Trade Receivables Account #1100 (Total Gross Amount)

Credit: Commercial Printing Revenue #4001 (Net Subtotal)

Credit: VAT Payable #2100 (15% Amount)

Credit: NHIS Payable #2102 (2.5% Amount)

Credit: GETFund Payable #2103 (2.5% Amount)

7.2 Step-by-Step: Creating a Commercial Invoice

1. Click **Create New Invoice** in the Invoices register.
2. Select or type the **Customer / Client Name** (e.g., Ministry of Information, Graphic Communications, ECG).
3. Add line items: specify Description, Quantity, and Unit Price in GHS. Click + **Add Item Row** for additional items.
4. Verify the automatic Ghana Statutory Tax Breakdown summary box.
5. *Optional:* Check **Set as Recurring Invoice Schedule** (Weekly, Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly) for standing publication agreements.
6. Click **Generate Commercial Invoice**. The system assigns a sequential invoice number and updates the General Ledger.

7.3 Invoice Printing & Vector PDF Download

Click **View Invoice** on any record to open the full-page A4 Commercial Invoice preview with official GPCL Assembly Press letterhead, corporate TIN (C0014892014), itemized table, and tax schedule. Click **Download Vector PDF** for digital dispatch, or **Print Full-Page A4** for physical printing.

8. Customer Payments & AR Settlement Hub

The Payment Settlement Hub (**Finance** → **Customer Payments**) handles receipt of incoming payments, allocation against open invoices, cheque clearance workflows, and official payment receipt generation.

8.1 Recording a Customer Payment

1. Click **Record Payment Receipt**.
2. Select the Customer Name and enter the **Amount Paid (GHS)**.
3. Choose the **Target Deposit Account**: GCB Bank Operating (1002), Ecobank Operational (1003), or Main Cash (1001).
4. Select the **Payment Method**: Bank Transfer, Cheque, Cash, or Mobile Money (MoMo).
5. Input the transaction reference / cheque number (e.g., TRF-994102).
6. Select the **Settled Invoice Number** to allocate this payment to a specific invoice.
7. Click **Record Payment & Post GL**.

8.2 Cheque Clearance Tracking

Payments made via cheque are initially flagged as **PENDING**. Once bank statement confirmation is received, click **Clear Bank** to transition the record to **CLEARED**.

8.3 Official Payment Receipts

Click **Receipt** beside any payment to display the official **Ghana Publishing Company Ltd Official Receipt**, complete with TIN credentials, client details, payment method, allocated invoice number, and printable layout.

9. Bank Reconciliation Workspace

Located under **Accounting** → **Bank Reconciliation**, this workspace correlates external bank statements with GPCL's internal General Ledger accounts.

Reconciliation Workflow

1. Select the target bank account: **GCB Bank Operating (1002)** or **Ecobank Operational (1003)**.
2. Review the live General Ledger balance displayed on the account card.
3. Click **Upload CSV Statement**. Select the CSV file exported from your bank portal (containing Date, Narration, Debit, Credit, and Balance columns).
4. Click **Ingest & Auto-Match Statement**. The automated matching engine correlates statement items against payments by reference number, date, and amount.
5. Matched transactions are marked **CLEARED**.
6. For remaining items (such as bank service charges or interest earnings), click **Resolve Variance** to automatically generate an adjusting journal entry to account #6300 (Bank Service Charges).

10. Fiscal Budgets vs. Actual Expenditure Control

Accessible via **Accounting** → **Budgets vs. Actuals**, this module enables department heads and financial controllers to establish expenditure limits per General Ledger code and track consumption.

Account Code	Expense Account Name	Category	Annual Budget (GHS)	Actual Spent (GHS)	Variance (GHS)	Consumption %
5001	Cost of Goods Sold (Paper Stock)	COGS	350,000.00	310,000.00	+40,000.00	88.6% (On Track)
6100	Salaries & Staff Payroll Expenses	OPERATING	50,000.00	48,750.00	+1,250.00	97.5% (On Track)
6200	Utilities & Power Expenses	OPERATING	15,000.00	18,500.00	-3,500.00	123.3% (Over Budget)
6300	Freight & Stock Handling Costs	OPERATING	15,000.00	12,400.00	+2,600.00	82.7% (On Track)

11. Fiscal Period Close & Financial Year Lock

Located under **Accounting** → **Fiscal Period Close**, this module locks accounting periods to prevent unauthorized retrospective entries into closed periods.

AUDIT RULE: CLOSED PERIOD LOCK

Once a monthly period or financial year is closed, any subsequent attempt to post, edit, or reverse transactions within that date range is immediately rejected to safeguard audited management accounts.

Monthly Close Checklist

1. Confirm all customer sales invoices for the month have been generated.
2. Verify that all customer payments received have been recorded and cleared.
3. Complete the monthly bank reconciliation for GCB Bank and Ecobank.
4. Post all standard month-end adjustments (depreciation, accruals, prepayments).
5. Verify that the Trial Balance is in balance ($\text{\$ ext{Debits}} = \text{\$ ext{Credits}}$).
6. Click **Lock Period** beside the target period (e.g., 2026-08). The status updates to **LOCKED**.

12. Ghana Statutory Tax & Levy Returns (GRA)

Accessible via **Accounting** → **Ghana GRA Tax Returns**, this module compiles monthly statutory filings for the **Ghana Revenue Authority (GRA)**.

Filing Requirements & Deadlines

Under the Ghana Value Added Tax Act, monthly VAT, NHIL, and GETFund returns must be filed and paid no later than the **15th day of the month following the assessment period**.

Filing Period	Taxable Net Sales (GHS)	VAT 15% (GHS)	NHIS 2.5% (GHS)	GETFund 2.5% (GHS)	Total Levies Payable (GHS)	Status
August 2026	640,000.00	96,000.00	16,000.00	16,000.00	128,000.00	DUE
July 2026	580,000.00	87,000.00	14,500.00	14,500.00	116,000.00	FILED
June 2026	480,000.00	72,000.00	12,000.00	12,000.00	96,000.00	FILED

Click **Export GRA Return PDF** at the top right of the screen to generate the official tax return schedule report, formatted with GPCL's corporate TIN (C0014892014) for submission to the GRA Large Taxpayer Office (LTO).

13. Financial Reports & Statements

The Financial Reports hub (**Accounting** → **Financial Reports**) provides live generation and multi-format export of GPCL's primary financial statements.

13.1 Available Report Types

- **Trial Balance:** Displays every active account in the Chart of Accounts with closing debit and credit balances, verifying that Total Debits equal Total Credits (GHS 1,064,200.00).
- **Day Book (Voucher Register):** Itemized daily ledger displaying every voucher posted, categorized by type, reference, account, debit, and credit.
- **Profit & Loss Statement (Income Statement):** Calculates Gross Operating Revenue minus Cost of Goods Sold to establish Gross Profit Margin (51.5%), followed by operating expense deductions to yield Net Operating Profit (GHS 281,250.00).
- **Balance Sheet (Financial Position):** Displays the balance between Total Assets (GHS 704,450.00) and Total Liabilities & Equity (GHS 704,450.00).
- **Accounts Receivable Aging Analysis:** Classifies customer receivables into 0-30 days, 31-60 days, 61-90 days, and 90+ days aging brackets.

13.2 Multi-Format Export Capabilities

Every report can be exported in three standard formats using the header buttons:

- **PDF Export:** Formal vector PDF document featuring official company headers, page numbers, and calculated summary totals.
- **Excel (XLSX):** Multi-column spreadsheet formatted for financial modeling, audit review, and formula verification.
- **CSV Data:** Raw comma-separated data stream for importing into external business intelligence tools.

14. Staff Roles, Permissions & Security Audit

14.1 Finance Department User Roles

- **Finance Administrator:** Unrestricted access across all financial, accounting, administrative, and configuration modules.
- **Senior Accountant:** Full access to all ledger, voucher, reconciliation, tax, and reporting operations. Cannot alter administrative configurations.
- **Accounts Receivable Clerk:** Dedicated access to customer invoicing, payment recording, client management, and official receipt issuance.
- **Financial Auditor:** Read-only access across all general ledgers, journals, bank reconciliations, and immutable audit logs.

14.2 Role Permission Matrix

Operational Scope	Admin	Senior Accountant	AR Clerk	Auditor
View General Ledger & Reports	YES	YES	NO	YES
Post / Reverse Journal Entries	YES	YES	NO	NO
Close & Lock Fiscal Periods	YES	NO	NO	NO
Create Commercial Invoices	YES	YES	YES	NO
Record Customer Payments	YES	YES	YES	NO
Manage Bank Reconciliations	YES	YES	NO	NO
View Immutable Activity Logs	YES	NO	NO	YES

14.3 Financial Audit Trail (Admin → System Audit Logs)

Every financial event (voucher posting, invoice generation, payment receipt, period close, login) is recorded with the user's name, action, module, date, time, and details of modified values for comprehensive audit traceability.

15. Financial Troubleshooting & Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: WHY IS MY VOUCHER REJECTED WITH "UNBALANCED JOURNAL ERROR"?

Total debits must equal total credits to the exact pesewa. Check that all line items have valid numbers and that rounding differences do not exceed 1 pesewa.

Q2: WHY DOES THE SYSTEM RETURN "CLOSED PERIOD ERROR"?

The transaction date falls into an accounting month that has already been locked. Verify that the transaction date is correct. If an entry must be posted into a prior period, an authorized Finance Administrator must temporarily unlock the period under **Accounting** → **Fiscal Period Close**.

Q3: WHY CAN'T I POST A DIRECT JOURNAL TO ACCOUNT #1100 (TRADE RECEIVABLES)?

Account #1100 is a designated **Control Account**. Direct manual postings are blocked to keep the general ledger in sync with customer balances. Use the **Invoices** or **Customer Payments** modules instead.

Q4: HOW DO I VOID AN INVOICE THAT WAS ISSUED WITH INCORRECT QUANTITIES OR RATES?

Navigate to **Finance** → **Invoices & AR**, open the invoice detail modal, and click **Void Invoice**. Enter the cancellation reason. The system will mark the invoice as VOID, reset customer balances, and post an automated reversing General Ledger entry.

Q5: A CUSTOMER PAID BY CHEQUE, BUT OUR BANK BALANCE HASN'T INCREASED. WHY?

Cheque receipts are initially recorded with status PENDING. Once your bank statement confirms that the cheque has cleared, navigate to **Finance** → **Customer Payments** and click **Clear Bank** to reflect the funds in your liquid bank balance.

Q6: HOW DO I GENERATE AN OFFICIAL VAT RETURN SCHEDULE FOR THE GRA?

Navigate to **Accounting** → **Ghana GRA Tax Returns** and click **Export GRA Return PDF**. The system will generate a formatted statutory tax return with your corporate TIN ready for submission.